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Stripe Webhook Setup Guide

Step-by-step instructions for registering the site's webhook endpoint in the Stripe Dashboard, so payments are correctly recorded and confirmation emails are sent.

Prepared for whoever manages the Stripe account (the "handler").
Covers: what a webhook is and why it matters · adding the endpoint · selecting the right events · retrieving and storing the signing secret · verifying it works · troubleshooting.

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SECTION 1

What a Webhook Is, and Why It's Needed Here

When a customer pays for a book on the site, Stripe processes the card payment on its own servers. The website itself doesn't know the payment succeeded unless Stripe actively tells it. A **webhook** is exactly that: a notification Stripe sends directly to the website the instant something happens — a successful payment, a failed payment, or a refund.

Without a correctly configured webhook, the site cannot:

- Record the order in the admin Orders page
- Add the buyer to the Customers list
- Send the buyer their automatic download-link email
- Update an order's status to "refunded" when a refund is issued from the admin panel

> **WHY THIS MATTERS RIGHT NOW**
>
> The site is now processing **real, live payments**. If the live-mode webhook isn't registered, customers can be charged successfully by Stripe while the website never finds out — meaning no order record, no customer record, and no email with their book. This step is not optional.

SECTION 2

Before You Start

1. Log in to **dashboard.stripe.com** with the account that owns this business's Stripe account.
2. Look at the toggle in the top-right corner of the dashboard. Make sure it is set to **Live mode**, not Test mode. Webhooks registered in Test mode will not receive real customer payments.

> **NOTE**

> Stripe treats Test mode and Live mode as two completely separate environments, each with its own webhooks and signing secrets. If a webhook was already set up while in Test mode, it will not work for real transactions — this guide is specifically for the Live mode endpoint.

SECTION 3

Adding the Webhook Endpoint — Step by Step

1. In the left-hand sidebar, click **Developers**, then click **Webhooks**.
2. Click the **+ Add endpoint** button (top-right of the Webhooks page).
3. In the **Endpoint URL** field, enter exactly the URL below (copy it precisely — no trailing slash, no extra characters):

ENDPOINT URL

```
https://www.ihuomairoaganachi.com/api/webhooks/stripe
```

4. Under **Select events to listen to**, choose **"Select events"** (not "receive all events") and check exactly these four:

EVENT	WHAT IT'S FOR
`checkout.session.completed`	Fires the instant a payment succeeds — creates the order, customer record, and sends the download email.
`checkout.session.async_payment_succeeded`	Covers payment methods that confirm a few moments after checkout rather than instantly.
`checkout.session.async_payment_failed`	Marks an order as failed if a delayed payment method ends up declining.
`charge.refunded`	Updates an order's status to "refunded" when a refund is issued from the admin panel or Stripe Dashboard.

5. Click **Add endpoint** to save it.

SECTION 4

Copying the Signing Secret

After the endpoint is created, Stripe takes you to its details page.

1. Find the **Signing secret** section (usually near the top-right of the endpoint's detail page).
2. Click **Reveal**. A value starting with `whsec_` will appear.
3. Click to copy it, or write it down somewhere secure immediately — like a real API key, it should not be shared casually or left in an unsecured note.

> **KEEP THIS SECRET SAFE**

> The signing secret proves to the website that a notification genuinely came from Stripe and hasn't been faked by someone else. Treat it exactly like a password — don't post it publicly, don't send it over unsecured channels if avoidable, and don't reuse the Test mode one; it must be the Live mode value from this endpoint specifically.

SECTION 5

Giving the Signing Secret to the Developer

The signing secret needs to be stored as an environment variable named `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET` in the website's hosting configuration (Vercel). This is the one step in this guide that isn't done from inside Stripe — pass the copied `whsec_...` value along to whoever manages the site's deployment (privately — not in an email thread or shared document that others can see), so it can be set correctly and the site redeployed.

SECTION 6

Verifying the Webhook Works

Once the secret has been set on the hosting side, confirm it's working:

1. Return to the endpoint's page under **Developers → Webhooks** in the Stripe Dashboard.
2. Look at the **Recent events** / delivery log at the bottom of the page after a real (or Stripe-sent test) payment.
3. Each event should show a green **Succeeded** status with a `200` response. A red/failed status means something needs attention (see Troubleshooting).
4. As a real-world check: after any successful sale, confirm the order appears in the site's admin **Orders** page and the buyer shows up under **Customers**.

SECTION 7

Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE
Event shows a **400** or "signature verification failed" in Stripe's delivery log	The `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET` stored on the hosting side doesn't match this endpoint's signing secret — usually because the Test mode value was used instead of Live mode, or it was copied incorrectly.
Event shows a **404**	The Endpoint URL has a typo — double check it against Section 3 exactly, including `https://` and no trailing slash.
Event shows **500**	Something failed on the website's side while processing the event — pass this along to the developer with the event ID from the Stripe Dashboard so they can check the logs.
A real purchase went through in Stripe, but no order appears on the site	The webhook likely isn't registered yet, or is registered under Test mode instead of Live mode — revisit Section 2 and 3.

SECTION 8

Quick Reference

FIELD	VALUE
Endpoint URL	`https://www.ihuomairoaganachi.com/api/webhooks/stripe`
Mode	Live
Events to select	`checkout.session.completed`, `checkout.session.async_payment_succeeded`, `checkout.session.async_payment_failed`, `charge.refunded`
Where the signing secret goes	Environment variable `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET` on the hosting platform (Vercel), Production environment